

Handover: "Tonight's Menus"

— replacing the Thali Builder

Heldi homepage · section #thali · July 2026 · design reference: *Tonights Table Mobile.dc.html*, option 4a (turn 4)

1. Overview

The interactive dish-by-dish builder in `components/thali-builder.tsx` is replaced by a **menu gallery**: five curated set menus (2 lunches, 3 dinners), each fitting one mobile screen, swiped horizontally. Instead of asking users to assemble a thali themselves, each menu shows at a glance what one spoonful of Heldi per bowl adds to a real meal — clearer for the older adults in the audience, and it demonstrates the "+20g and upwards" story immediately.

The section is no longer called "thali builder" anywhere. Working name: **"Tonight's Menus"**, under the existing eyebrow **PUT IT ON TONIGHT'S TABLE**.

2. What is removed

- The 18-dish selectable list, its categories, and the `onTable / heldiIn` boolean state.
- The two-step "Add to table → Stir in Heldi" toggles and the disabled-toggle logic.
- The animated running-total tween (`useAnimatedNumber`) and both summary cards (`thali-summary--sticky / --desktop`).
- The 3-step "how the builder works" list in the intro.
- All related CSS blocks in `app/globals.css`: `.thali-builder*`, `.thali-summary*`, `.thali-menu*`, `.thali-category`, `.dish-row*`, `.toggle` — plus their media queries.

3. What is new

One new component (suggested: `components/menu-gallery.tsx`) rendered inside the existing `<section class="section section--ink" id="thali">` shell (keep the anchor so the nav link "Tonight's table" still works, or rename it and update `heldi-homepage.tsx`).

- **Header** — eyebrow, H2 "Tonight's menus.", and one lede sentence with inline emphasis (no info chips, no repeated footnotes): "Five ways to lay the table — swipe through. Dishes in **gold** are **boosted with Heldi** — +10g of protein per tablespoon — counted for **one person's plate**." The two gold phrases render in marigold; the two bold phrases in cream.
- **Menu cards** — one card per menu: meal tag pill (LUNCH / DINNER), Rozha One title, double rule, courses (TO START / THE MAIN / ON THE SIDE) with dotted leaders, then a summary block: "From the food Xg", a solid **Heldi band** ("Boosted with Heldi · N tbsp" / "+Ng"), and the big "ON

THE TABLE Xg" total.

- **Per-dish Heldi totals** — dishes that take Heldi show their *with-Heldi* total inside a filled pill circle (base grams + 10); plain dishes show plain grams. The circle uses the same fill as the Heldi band so the two read as one system.
- **Alternating schemes** — cards alternate cream and marigold (both 3px ink border, 18px radius, hard sticker shadow). On cream cards the Heldi highlight is marigold-on-ink-text; on marigold cards it inverts to ink-on-marigold.
- **Mobile gallery** — horizontal scroll with snap-to-centre and equal peek either side; nav dots underneath, active dot flattens into a 24×6px gold pill; dots are tappable (30px hit target) and smooth-scroll to their card.
- **Desktop** — no carousel: the same cards in a wrapping, centre-justified row (see option 2b in the design file).
- **Veg / non-veg variant** — The Friday Feast card carries a "SELECT YOUR MAIN" label and two radio-style chips (✓ VEG / NON-VEG) that swap the main (paneer butter masala 12g ↔ butter chicken 20g) and recompute all three summary numbers. Structure this so any menu can declare variants later.

4. The five menus (data)

Gold rows take Heldi (1 tbsp = +10g, the existing grams prop). All gram values are illustrative placeholders — confirm real per-dish protein values with the client before shipping.

Menu (tag · scheme)	Courses (g = food protein; • = Heldi)	Food / Heldi / Total
The Weeknight Dinner DINNER · cream	Papad & chutney 2g · Dal tadka 9g • · Jeera rice 4g · Cucumber raita 3g •	18g / +20g / 38g
The Saturday Lunch LUNCH · marigold	Aloo chaat 4g • · Chana masala 8g • · Steamed rice 3g · Bowl of dahi 5g •	20g / +30g / 50g
The Friday Feast DINNER · cream · variants	Vegetable samosa 3g · VEG: Paneer butter masala 12g • / NON-VEG: Butter chicken 20g • · Jeera rice 4g · Boondi raita 4g •	veg 23g / +20g / 43g non-veg 31g / +20g / 51g
The Light Lunch LUNCH · marigold	Dahi puri 5g • · Kadhi 7g • · Steamed rice 3g · Roasted papad 2g	17g / +20g / 37g
The Sunday Thali DINNER · cream	Samosa chaat 5g • · Dal makhani 11g • · Two rotis 4g · Cucumber raita 3g •	23g / +30g / 53g

5. Spec values

- **Card:** 292px wide on mobile (300px desktop), `border: 3px solid var(--ink)`, radius 18px, padding ~16px 15px. Sticker shadow: cream cards `6px 6px 0 rgb(237 163 29 / 90%)`, marigold cards `6px 6px 0 rgb(248 240 222 / 85%)`. Cards stretch to equal height; summary block pinned to the bottom (`margin-top: auto`).
- **Scroller:** flex row, 12px gap, `scroll-snap-type: x mandatory`, `scroll-snap-align: center`, 49px side padding on a 390px viewport (equal peek), hidden scrollbars. Active-dot index = `round(scrollLeft / 304)`.
- **Dots:** inactive 8px circle at 25% cream; active 24×6px marigold pill; 250ms transition; 30px square hit target; tap smooth-scrolls to `i × 304`.
- **Per-dish circle:** ≥40px wide × 30px pill, Rozha One 15px, band colors.
- **Heldi band:** radius 10px, 9px 12px padding; label Gelasio 12.5px semibold; value Rozha One 21px.
- **Type:** existing tokens — Rozha One for titles/numerals, Gelasio for everything else; colors from the existing custom properties only.
- **Copy rules:** "Boosted with Heldi" (not "stirred in" in labels); "tbsp"/"tablespoon", never "scoop"; totals always per person. State the per-tbsp and per-person facts once in the header — never repeat them per card.

6. Accessibility & behavior notes

- Veg/non-veg chips are a radio group (`role="radiogroup"`, `aria-checked`); dots get `aria-label="Menu N of 5"`.
- All tap targets ≥ 30px (dots) / ≥ 36px (chips); respect `prefers-reduced-motion` for smooth-scrolling and dot transitions.
- The gallery must degrade to a plain vertical/wrapped list when scroll-snap is unavailable; desktop never uses the carousel.
- Card content is fixed-height-safe: every menu fits a 760px viewport including header and dots — if copy grows, cut copy, don't shrink type below 14px body / 10px labels.

7. Open items for the client

- Real protein values for every dish (all current numbers are placeholders), especially butter chicken (20g assumed).
- Confirm the per-tablespoon dose (+10g) — this reuses the existing `grams` prop from `app/page.tsx`.
- Should more menus get non-veg variants? The data model supports it per menu.
- Final menu names, and whether the gallery fully replaces the builder or sits alongside it.
- Section anchor: keep `#thali` or migrate to `#menus` (update nav in `heldi-homepage.tsx`).